

Top Three Recommendations

Training Ledger | National AI Challenge 2026

1 1. Commit to one high-frequency decision wedge

The strongest version of Training Ledger is not “AI fitness intelligence.” It is “help a self-coached lifter on a defined 8–12 week block decide what to do before the next planned strength session.” The initial recommendation set should be limited to four reversible actions—progress, repeat, reduce volume or defer a top set—with a visible rationale and human approval. This directly responds to the observed user need for flexibility and judgement rather than treating a wearable score as an instruction. [1]

The pilot cohort should be recruited from a setting where programme structure and session frequency are already present, such as powerlifting clubs, strength-and-conditioning groups, coached functional-fitness communities or independent personal trainers. Success should be measured as recurring pre-session use, not number of integrations or number of metrics displayed.

2 2. Make the evidence card the product, and build a defensible outcome loop

Do not attempt to out-score WHOOP or Oura. WHOOP already captures structured strength inputs and claims to combine muscular with cardiovascular load, while Oura is extending readiness and activity data into partner workout recommendations. [2] [3] A proprietary readiness score would be technically expensive, scientifically vulnerable and commercially undifferentiated.

Instead, every recommendation should expose its inputs, missing data, confidence and counterfactual, then record the athlete’s approval, modification or rejection and the next session’s outcome. That produces the only credible future moat: consented, longitudinal recommendation-to-outcome data for a narrow use case. It also keeps the product aligned with the limitations of consumer-measurement validity identified in a review covering 24 systematic reviews. [4]

3 3. Replace headline TAM with a paid proof plan and a data-governance gate

The original Ireland figure based on all sport participants overstates the beachhead. Use the stricter market narrative: 176.7k weekly weightlifters as the relevant Irish ceiling, a 21.9k core user proxy once national wearable and workout-planning usage are applied, and 100 paid users as the first credible milestone. The proposed €99/year price is €8.25/month; it is a hypothesis to test through an annual-payment offer, not a validated fact.

Run a 300-person design-partner cohort for 12 weeks, with eligibility restricted to athletes who follow a structured plan and consent to named data sources. Before any growth spend, require: sustained weekly decision use, qualitative evidence that the explanation is more useful than the current wearable-plus-log workflow, at least 25% paid conversion among eligible users, and no critical privacy or safety incident. Health-related data demand an explicit governance design: explain the purpose of each data source,

minimise collection, preserve deletion controls and use an appropriate Article 9 condition, including explicit consent where relevant. [5]

4 Why these three changes matter for the Challenge

The challenge catalogue rewards a real user and buyer, measurable value, an end-to-end agentic workflow, human accountability, traceability and responsible data use. The revised approach makes those criteria observable in a two-week demonstration: an athlete connects data, a workflow normalises and verifies it, a bounded recommendation is drafted, the athlete approves or rejects it, and the system stores a traceable outcome. The commercial claim then rests on measured behaviour rather than a broad consumer-fitness narrative.

5 References

- [1] Ibrahim, A. H., Beaumont, C. T. and Strohacker, K., “Exploring Regular Exercisers’ Experiences with Readiness/Recovery Scores Produced by Wearable Devices,” **Applied Psychophysiology and Biofeedback**, 2024.
- [2] WHOOP, “Strength Trainer: Quantify Muscular Load for Smarter Training”, 2026.
- [3] Oura, “All-New Updates to Oura’s Activity Features”, 2025.
- [4] Doherty, C. et al., “Keeping Pace with Wearables,” **Sports Medicine**, 2024.
- [5] Irish Data Protection Commission, “Processing of health data”.